When Philly PD Fails You

They didn't come. Here's who will.

The suffering was real. The outcome is useful. Given away free.

Standing up for your rights is not snitching. It is citizenship. You are a United States citizen. Human decency is owed to you by law. Being upset after you break does not help you in Philadelphia. These steps do.

Read this first

In Philadelphia, calling 911 over and over when they already said they are not coming does not make them come faster. It makes the next dispatcher hang up. This guide shows you the other doors. Follow the steps in order. Write things down while they are happening. Do not wait until you are crying and exhausted.

1. Skip your district. Call State Police.

What to do:

1. Call **215-452-5216** (Pennsylvania State Police, Troop K, Philadelphia barracks, 2201 Belmont Avenue).

2. Say: “I live in Philadelphia. My local district is not responding. I need a State Police officer for [noise / harassment / threats].”

3. Give your address and what is happening right now. Ask for the incident number.

4. Write the number and the officer’s name in your notes.

They cover Philadelphia County. You do not call your district back. You call them.

2. File where it lands — CPOC

What to do:

1. Call **215-685-0891** or email CPOC@phila.gov.

2. Say: “I want to file a complaint against the Philadelphia Police Department for not responding to my calls.”

3. Give dates, times, and how many times you called. Give any incident numbers you already have.

4. Ask them to email you a copy of what they logged.

They are civilians, not Internal Affairs. They can sit in on interviews with you and watch the investigation.

3. Private criminal complaint (no police report needed)

What to do:

1. Go to **1425 Arch Street, 4th Floor** or call **215-686-9848**.

2. Bring: the person’s full name and address, any district control number, your notes, and any video or photos.

3. Tell them: “I want to file a private criminal complaint for harassment / threats / noise.”

4. They will give you a form. Fill it out. Keep a copy.

You do not need the police to write a report first. The law lets you go straight to the court.

4. What the law protects (plain English)

Harassment (18 Pa.C.S. § 2709). Someone keeps doing something that has no real reason except to bother or scare you. Examples: calling you over and over, following you, sending ugly messages. It can be a misdemeanor.

Cyber harassment of a child (18 Pa.C.S. § 2709(a.1)). Electronic messages that target a child’s looks, health, or safety.

Noise ordinance. Quiet hours are 9:00 PM to 8:00 AM. If the sound can be heard more than 100 feet away, it is a violation. First fine is $100–$300. File it on the Philly 311 app or call 311.

Parental rights (18 Pa.C.S. § 509 and 23 Pa.C.S. § 6304). You are allowed to use reasonable force to keep your child safe or to stop bad behavior. That includes stopping a child from running into the street or correcting them. It does not mean you can hurt them. The law says reasonable force for supervision is not child abuse.

5. Cease and desist — what to write and how to send it

You do not need a lawyer. Write a short letter. Send it certified mail with return receipt. The green card that comes back is proof they got it.

What the letter must say:

• Your full name and address
• Their full name and address
• The exact thing they are doing (dates and times if you have them)
• "Stop this immediately."
• "If you continue, I will use this letter as evidence that you were told to stop."

Example (copy and change the names):

> *"October 22, 2026*
> *Dear [Neighbor Name],*
> *On October 5 and October 6 you played loud music past 11 PM and yelled threats at my child. This is harassment and a noise violation. Stop immediately. If you continue, I will file a private criminal complaint and use this letter as proof you were warned. — [Your Name]"*

Take it to the post office. Ask for certified mail with return receipt. Keep the receipt and the green card when it comes back.

6. Free legal backup

• **Community Legal Services** — 215-981-3700. Call for new clients. Walk-ins Tuesdays and Thursdays 9 AM–12 PM at 1424 Chestnut Street. Family / DHS hotline: 215-981-3765.
• **Philly Tenant Hotline** — 267-443-2500
• You can file a Protection from Abuse (PFA) order yourself at the courthouse if there are threats or violence.

Keep notes while it is happening

Do not wait until the next day. Write it down in the moment.

What to write each time:

• Date and time
• What happened (one sentence)
• Who was there
• What you did (called 911, called State Police, took video)
• Any number they gave you

Example note:

> *"Oct 5, 11:42 PM. Loud music and yelling from next door. Child crying. Called 911. Dispatcher said they are not sending anyone. Took video on phone. Called State Police 215-452-5216. They gave me incident # K-2026-12345."*

Keep the original video files. Do not only take screenshots. Back them up to a cloud drive or a second phone.

Founder note

I spent fifty-nine nights learning this the hard way so you do not have to. Fifteen calls in twenty-four hours. Three visits. A sergeant who would not come. A neighbor who looked me in the face and lied. I was exhausted. I was a mother alone with a four-year-old. And I nearly broke before I found the back door. This guide is that back door. You are not a byproduct of someone else's failure to act. You have rights. Use them.

— Tiny

This is not anti-police. It is the back door when the front door will not open.